MODULE 4 INSIDER PLAYBOOK - THE 21-DAY CAMPAIGN: The Add-Cycle Clock & Chart Mechanics

Executive insider briefing - confidential

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Executive briefing. The execution layer under the lessons. Read after 4.1-4.4.

THE ADD-CYCLE CLOCK (SCHEDULE YOUR CAMPAIGN INSIDE RADIO'S RHYTHM)

Day	Industry reality	Your move
Mon	Rotation boards refresh; add decisions from Friday reads	Load + verify (no sends)
Tue	New-music Tuesday: most commercial add dates	Wave 1 - first half of the list
Wed-Thu	College MDs process; specialty hosts plan weekends	Wave 2; touch-2 value to wave 1
Fri	Week's rotation locks; specialty show prep	Log; no cold pitches after 11am
Sat-Sun	Specialty shows air; hosts are reachable and excited	Host DMs, thank-yous, value drops
Next Mon	Fresh rotation board	Touch-3 grace closes land on a fresh week

The insider rule: the campaign is a weekly machine, not a 21-day sprint. Each week of the campaign rides one rotation cycle. If you fire wave 1 on a Thursday and wave 2 on a Friday afternoon, you've just burned two weeks of cycles in one send - which is why the Load -> Tue/Thu -> next-Monday rhythm is the actual operating system.

THE IMPACT-DATE MOVE (HOW LABELS TIME A CAMPAIGN)

> *"Official impact: [date]. Rotation-ready. We're servicing [NUMBER] markets that week."*

Your version: give your campaign an internal impact date. Announce it in the pitch - "servicing [city] stations the week of [date]" - and time wave 1 exactly 1-2 weeks before the impact so the add lands on the week. PDs are calendar animals; a date converts "maybe" into "when?"

THE COLLEGE CHART EXPRESS (SERVICE -> ADDS -> CHART ->

SECOND WAVE)

- Service (wk 1): 10 college slots + 4 specialty - the Tier-1 allocation.
- Adds (wk 2): rotation boards pick up; you track adds daily in T4.4.
- Chart (wk 3): college stations report to NACC/RMR. Chart position is evidence.
- Second wave (wk 4): the chart listing becomes the proof line for every commercial and mid-metro pitch: "charting at [NUMBER] college stations, NACC top [NUMBER]."

Run this loop and you're doing what labels pay $2,000+ per record for - with 20 stations and 21 days. The first add's real job is to start the chart. The chart's real job is to make the next 20 stations easy.

THE ROTATION-UPGRADE STRATEGY (THE KILLER FOLLOW-UP)

- Week after the add: thank-you + listener-feedback receipts (streams, tickets, requests).
- Two weeks after: second receipt - usually market-specific ("your metro streams +30%").
- Three weeks after: the upgrade ask: "Is there a path for [SONG] to move into medium? We can support with [asset]."

The upgrade ask is the single most winnable ask in the industry - it's a category change, not a new favor - and it's the one almost no independent ever makes.

THE SPIN-TRACKING DISCIPLINE (WHAT LABELS CHASE)

Spins are the industry's raw score. Track weekly per station: adds, spins, rotation category, chart position. The total spin count is your momentum number - the number that appears on the second-wave pitch, the sync package, the sponsor deck, and the booking email. Without weekly spin tracking, you're running a campaign without a scoreboard. With it, you're running a business.

THE 3-TOUCH ESCALATION PSYCHOLOGY (THE INSIDER VERSION)

- Touch 1: the ask lands. Silence = the PD is not deciding yet (busy, not hostile).
- Touch 2 (value): the receipt or asset gives them a new reason. This is where the "busy but interested" cohort converts.
- Touch 3 (grace): the close. Politeness + an open door. This is where the "I need a deadline" cohort converts - and where the "no" cohort converts into a relationship instead of a burn.

The system's secret: all three touches are about the next campaign too. Touch 3's grace close is what makes touch 1 of your next release warmer than touch 3 of this one.

THE ONE SECRET MOST ARTISTS NEVER LEARN

Adds happen in waves, not trickles. If you see 2-3 adds land in one morning, the rest of the week's board is likely moving too - that's the rotation cycle turning. Watch the wave: when it turns, escalate the second-wave pitch to every station that hasn't added yet, with the fresh proof. Timing the second wave off the first wave's momentum is the difference between 5 adds and 11.

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